

Florian Strauf

Location: Mount Maunganui, New Zealand | Email: florian@learnedlate.com | LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/florian-strauf-50800965

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A high-velocity, forward-deployed Solutions Architect and former CTO with over 20 years of experience bridging massive enterprise complexity with agile, zero-to-one product execution. Exceptional track record of taking ambiguous customer requirements, aligning them with C-suite business strategy, and independently engineering production-ready validation systems. Brings deep expertise across enterprise solution architecture, SAP ecosystem integration, and technical leadership — with a current focus on modern AI automation, agentic workflows, and complex data orchestrations across legacy and modern tech stacks.

CORE PILLARS OF EXPERTISE

Forward-Deployed Delivery & Prototyping: Expert at embedding with clients to rapidly dissect complex problems, build functional MVPs from scratch, and validate production pipelines without relying on heavy supporting infrastructure.

Enterprise Architecture & Integration: Deep foundational expertise navigating complex legacy enterprise ecosystems (including 15+ years of core SAP DNA), ensuring modern software architectures seamlessly integrate with messy systems-of-record.

Technical Leadership & Zero-to-One Execution: Proven capability as a startup founder and CTO, driving technical strategy, scaling infrastructure, and managing successful product acquisitions.

AI Automation & Full-Stack Engineering: Hands-on developer specializing in building modern LLM/RAG pipelines, task orchestration frameworks, and robust backends using Node.js, PostgreSQL, Rust, Python, and modular automation.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent AI Automation Engineer & Product Builder

Learned Late / Independent Practice | 2024 – Present

- Designed, built, and operate production AI automation systems and agentic workflows from ambiguous requirements, rapidly turning ideas into measurable results. Focus on LLM/RAG pipelines, task orchestration, and complex data integrations across modern and legacy systems.
- Built and run a fully agentic SEO workflow automating keyword research, content generation, cannibalisation analysis, publishing, and performance-driven iteration — currently generating 600,000+ monthly search impressions and thousands of organic clicks with zero ad spend.
- Delivered a production-ready ArcGIS spatial data integration for the New Zealand Kiwifruit industry, mapping complex geospatial datasets into core operational business workflows.
- Developed and maintain live Rust (rig) + Python AI pipelines as a rapid experimentation environment for RAG retrieval tuning, content operations automation, build-vs-buy decisions, and agentic tool orchestration.
- Create technical roadmaps, system architectures, and visual strategy assets to support AI transformation initiatives for businesses and my own product initiatives.

Founder & Builder, Days to Expiry

Options Income SaaS | 2025 – Present

- Founded and built a niche options-income SaaS from concept to a small base of ~10 paying users, demonstrating end-to-end product delivery from broker-statement ingestion to AI-assisted trade analytics.
- Parsed and normalized broker statements into a structured, options-focused portfolio view, then layered on AI-driven analysis to help users evaluate covered-call, put-selling, and other income strategies against their actual holdings.
- Iterated continuously based on early-user feedback; while the venture remained modest in scale, it provided hands-on validation of rapid MVP delivery, RAG-based market analysis, and production monitoring in a regulated-adjacent domain.

CTO & Technical Co-Founder

Web3 / Crypto Startup (Acquired) | 2021 – 2024

- Led the end-to-end technical strategy, architecture, and engineering lifecycle for a high-growth startup from inception through a successful business sale.
- Served as a hands-on technical executive, balancing high-level investor/C-suite relations with concrete backend architecture design.
- Grew the Forgd.com platform from concept to 1,000+ users in under 12 months, scaling the engineering team from 4 to 14.
- Built and led a 3,000-member consulting community and token-launch SaaS for modelling supply/demand curves, running the business through acquisition by Forgd.com.

Senior Enterprise Architect

SAP & SER Group | 2006 – 2021

- Delivered high-level strategic technical advisory directly to enterprise board members, mapping complex software requirements to corporate roadmaps.
- Designed and implemented core architecture integrations within the SAP ecosystem, establishing robust content archiving and data-handling systems.
- Served as Senior Solution Architect in the SAP Centre of Excellence, connecting customer requirements to solution architecture, roadmap planning, and product extension strategy for Intelligent Asset Management.
- Shaped SAP's board-level strategy for emerging AI-adjacent and decentralised technologies, including crypto payments, token-based revenue models, and Catena-X / Gaia-X supply-chain carbon use cases across the German automotive industry.
- Acted as trusted advisor to Fortune Global 100 / Fortune 500 organisations, including APM Terminals, Port of Hamburg, Port of Singapore, and Port of Rotterdam, owning solution architecture from concept through production handover.
- Led technical delivery teams from PoC to live production cloud environments, specialising in IoT, spatial/mapping integrations, data-driven architectures, and custom SAP extensions.
- Led cloud customers out of escalation by analysing and improving system performance; recognised with SAP Catalyst / Fast Track awards in 2016, 2017, 2018, and 2019.

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Languages & Frameworks: Node.js, JavaScript, Python, TypeScript, Google Apps Script.

Databases & Infra: PostgreSQL, Relational Database Design, Enterprise Cloud Architecture.

AI & Orchestration: LLM/RAG pipelines, Task Automation Tools, Embeddings, Vector Stores.

Enterprise Ecosystems: Deep SAP ERP integration, ECM (Enterprise Content Management), SAP BTP

EDUCATION

- **Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.),** FOM University of Applied Sciences for Economics and Management, Köln/Bonn, Germany (2014)
- **Apprenticeship as Development Consultant,** IHK Germany (2008)

ADDITIONAL ACTIVITIES

- **Writing:** Over 2,300 readers follow my writing at [LearnedLate](#).